

Sterling McKinley

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Skills

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS EC2, VPC, S3, RDS, Infrastructure as Code Terraform, Ansible

Site Reliability: Root Cause Analysis, Error Budgets, SLI/SLO/SLA, MTTA/MTTD/MTTR, Disaster Recovery, ITIL Framework (Incident, Change, Problem Management)

Monitoring/Observability: Datadog, New Relic, Dynatrace, Prometheus, Grafana, AWS CloudWatch, Observe

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, EKS, ECS, Docker

CI/CD & Version Control: GitHub, GitHub Actions, GitLab, Jenkins, Bitbucket, IBM UrbanCode Deploy

Operating Systems & Middleware: Linux RHEL, Ubuntu), Windows Server IIS, AIX, Solaris, Tomcat, JBoss, WebSphere

Programming Languages & Scripting: Python, Bash

Automation/AI: GitHub Copilot, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Windsurf

Tools: Visual Studio, Confluence, Jira, PagerDuty, ServiceNow, G Suite, Microsoft Office Suite, Microsoft Teams, Slack, Zoom, Postman

Experience

Capital One

Chicago, Illinois

Platform Engineer / Site Reliability Engineer

01/2023 - Present

- Champion operational readiness, cloud-native resiliency, and continuous compliance across an enterprise portfolio of 500+ microservices and applications within Intelligent Foundations & Experiences (IFX).
- Spearhead SLI/SLO definition and telemetry standards across critical AWS workloads; engineered multi-window burn-rate alerts that yielded a 93% SLO attainment rate and reduced critical production incidents by 30%.
- Modernize observability platforms across New Relic, Observe, and CloudWatch; facilitate blameless postmortems and systematic root-cause analyses (RCA) that cut service interruption durations by 20%.
- Provision and standardize scalable AWS cloud infrastructure (EKS, ECS, EC2, Lambda, RDS) using Terraform modules to ensure secure, reproducible, multi-AZ production environments.
- Build Python and Bash self-service automation workflows to remove deployment bottlenecks, streamline developer experience, and maintain zero-downtime CI/CD releases.
- Integrate AI engineering tools (GitHub Copilot, Gemini, Windsurf) into operational workflows to automate telemetry extraction, log parsing, and recurring maintenance tasks.

PNC

Remote

Infrastructure Configuration Consultant

07/2019 - 01/2023

- Served as Tier-3 escalation lead for 24/7/365 production operations across enterprise core banking platforms, troubleshooting high-severity incidents and driving rapid MTTR.
- Engineered, patched, and maintained enterprise middleware and container environments (OpenShift, WebSphere, JBoss) on high-availability RHEL and Windows Server platforms.
- Executed deep-dive root cause analysis by diagnosing application thread/heap dumps, OS bottlenecks, and network anomalies to prevent recurring system failures.
- Managed end-to-end release delivery pipelines using IBM UrbanCode Deploy and Bitbucket, automating configuration scripts and cutting deployment failure rates by 20%.
- Developed automated health-check scripts and proactive synthetic monitoring to detect system degradation before business impact.
- Monitored applications and systems to track performance, proactively troubleshoot, and automate system management to prevent disruptions.

Application Integrator

07/2018 - 07/2019

- Provided technical support and platform administration for the Federal Reserve Bank of New York Auction Reporting (TAAPS) critical financial application.
- Deployed, configured, and monitored multi-tier enterprise web application infrastructure on IBM WebSphere Application Server ND and IBM HTTP Server.
- Collaborated with security and compliance teams to enforce stringent financial, SOC 2, and regulatory security standards across underlying host systems.

Projects

sre-3tier-terraform: Designed a highly available, multi-AZ AWS architecture provisioned entirely through Terraform. Conducted chaos engineering experiments using AWS Fault Injection Simulator (FIS) to validate auto-healing and disaster recovery mechanisms under simulated outage conditions.

multi-tier cloud-native observability – Architected an end-to-end containerized telemetry pipeline utilizing Docker Compose, Prometheus, and production Grafana dashboards to monitor distributed services with real-time alerting.

ai-chatbot-with-amazon-bedrock – Engineered a conversational AI chatbot using Python and the Amazon Bedrock Converse API with custom Guardrails to automate internal operations and incident runbook lookups.

game-day-notifications – Developed an event-driven AWS serverless architecture leveraging Python, AWS Lambda, EventBridge, and SNS to dispatch automated real-time SMS/Email status updates.

Certifications

Google AI Professional Certificate – Google

AWS Certified AI Practitioner (AIF-C01) – Amazon Web Services

Reliability Engineering: Measuring and Managing Reliability – Google

Google AI Essentials – Google

KCNA: Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate – The Linux Foundation

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner – Amazon Web Services

Education

Eastern Illinois University
Bachelor of Science in Management Information Systems

Charleston, Illinois

Kura Labs
Cloud Engineer/Site Reliability Engineering – Apprenticeship

Virtual
07/2022 - 12/2022